

LobsterLog

Electronic Logbook for Lobster Harvesters

PROVIDER'S INSTRUCTIONS

ELOG Client Application Standard — §17 Compliance Document

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Fisheries and Oceans Canada — Atlantic Regions

Lobster Fishing Areas: LFA 34 (Maritimes) and all applicable Atlantic subforms

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1. About This Document

This Provider's Instructions document is produced by Jonathon Nickerson (LobsterLog) in accordance with §17 of the DFO ELOG Client Application Standard v6.1. It is separate from and complementary to the DFO Instructions document (§18), which is produced by Fisheries and Oceans Canada.

This document instructs lobster harvesters on how to use LobsterLog specifically to complete their electronic logbook as required by DFO. It must be accessible at all times, including when no Internet connection is available.

This document covers:

- How to set up LobsterLog for your region and licence
- How to create and submit a lobster logbook entry (Form 234)
- How to complete required prerequisite forms (Form 222 — Marine Mammal; Form 233 — Inactivity)
- How to manage data groups, close sections, and handle corrections
- Support contacts for app-related issues

Note

Licence conditions may refer to this document. Always ensure you have the current version installed on your device. The app is available on the Apple App Store and Google Play Store.

2. Getting Started

2.1 Downloading LobsterLog

LobsterLog is available for iPhone (iOS 14 or later) and Android (version 8 or later). Search “LobsterLog” in the App Store or Google Play, or visit lobsterlog.ca for direct links.

2.2 First Launch — Privacy Notice & Attestation

On first launch, LobsterLog will display a Privacy Notice. You must accept this notice to proceed. This is a one-time step.

On every subsequent launch, you will be asked to confirm a Fisheries Act Attestation, certifying that the information you enter is true, accurate, and complete. This attestation is required by DFO and must be accepted before accessing the logbook.

2.3 Setting Up Your Captain Profile

Before activating DFO ELOG, complete your Captain Profile. Navigate to the Profile tab and enter:

- Your name (Operator Name)
- Vessel name
- Vessel Number (VRN) — enter exactly as it appears on your licence
- Home port and location details

Important

These values are used in every XML submission to DFO. Incorrect values will result in rejected submissions.

2.4 Activating DFO ELOG

To activate the DFO ELOG feature, navigate to Settings > DFO ELOG Setup and complete the following steps:

1. Select your region: Quebec (QC), Gulf (GLF), Maritimes (MAR), or Newfoundland & Labrador (NL)
2. Enter your Fishing Licence Number exactly as it appears on your licence
3. Enter your **Licence Holder's FIN** exactly as it appears on your licence
4. Enter your ELOG Key — this is provided by DFO. Contact DFO Client Support at 1-877-535-7307 (Mon–Fri, 08:00–21:00 Atlantic) or visit dfo-mpo.gc.ca/elogs if you do not have your key.
5. Tap Activate DFO ELOG and complete the in-app purchase for the DFO ELOG Season Pass.

3. Creating a Logbook Entry (Form 234)

Each fishing trip requires a separate logbook entry. Tap the + button on the main screen to begin a new entry. Entries are saved locally on your device until you transmit them to DFO.

3.1 General Information

The General Information section is pre-populated from your Captain Profile. Verify the following are correct before proceeding:

- Vessel Number (VRN)
- Fishing Licence Number
- Licence Holder's FIN
- Region / Subform

3.2 Fishing Trip Dates

Enter the date of your fishing trip. The app uses your device clock for timestamps. Ensure your device date and time are set correctly before entering data.

3.3 Bait Used

The Bait Used section is required for all regions. For each bait entry, provide:

- Bait type (select from the list for your region)
- Bait condition (fresh, frozen, salted, etc.) — mandatory or blocked depending on bait type per DFO rules
- Weight of bait used
- Data group close date — tap Close Section when bait information is complete

Important

Once a section is closed, it cannot be modified within the app. Contact LobsterLog support if a correction is needed after closing.

3.4 Personal Consumption (PCONS)

If you kept any catch for personal consumption, record it in this section. For each species:

- Select the species from the list
- Enter the weight (the app accepts pounds and converts to kilograms for DFO submission)
- Select size category: Small/Canner or Large/Market for lobster; unsized for all other species
- Close the section when complete

3.5 Fishing Effort

The Fishing Effort section records your trap sets. For each set of traps, enter:

- Number of traps hauled
- Gear type and subtype (NL region only)

- Set and haul coordinates — the app can read your device GPS automatically, or you can enter coordinates manually
- Soak time (not required for the Maritimes region)
- Targeted species
- Catches by species — enter weight in pounds; the app converts for submission
- Landing details

3.6 Region-Specific Sections

Some sections appear only for specific regions:

- Hail In / Hail Out — Maritimes (MAR) region only, and only for certain fishing areas. Record your hail times as required.
- Transfer section — Quebec (QC) region only. Record any transfers as required.
- Crew Number — Quebec and Maritimes regions only.
- Port of Departure — Quebec and Newfoundland & Labrador regions only.
- Port of Landing — all regions.
- Gear Subtype — Newfoundland & Labrador region only.
- Observer Trip Number — Maritimes region only, when applicable.

By design

LobsterLog displays only the fields your own region requires. You will never be asked to enter information that does not apply to your region.

4. Closing Sections and Data Groups

DFO requires that each data section (data group) be formally closed before submission. In LobsterLog, each section has a Close Section button. Tap this when you have finished entering data for that section.

When a section is closed:

- The close timestamp is automatically recorded and will be included in your XML submission
- The section is locked and displayed as read-only
- You cannot modify the section within the app

If a correction is needed after a section is closed: Contact LobsterLog support at support@lobsterlog.com. Data corrections require DFO approval before any modification can be made. Do not attempt to delete and re-enter a closed entry.

5. Submitting to DFO

Once all required sections are complete and closed, your entry is ready to transmit. Navigate to the DFO Logs screen and tap Send to DFO on the entry you wish to submit.

Before sending, LobsterLog will:

- Validate your XML against DFO's schema — any validation errors will be shown and must be corrected before submission
- Require an active Internet connection to transmit
- Encrypt and sign the submission using your ELOG Key
- Record the submission in a local transmission register (retained for 3 years)

If a submission fails:

- A red failure badge will appear on the log entry
- Tap Retry to attempt resubmission
- If the error persists, contact LobsterLog support with the error code shown

DFO Instructions: The DFO Instructions document (Form 234, v234.7) is available within the app at all times, including offline. Access it via Settings > DFO Instructions. This document is produced by DFO and describes what information is required at a regulatory level.

6. Form 222 — Marine Mammal Interactions

Form 222 is required whenever you have an interaction with a marine mammal during a fishing trip. This form must be submitted to DFO separately from Form 234.

To submit Form 222 in LobsterLog:

1. Navigate to the DFO Logs screen
2. Tap Marine Mammal Report (Form 222)
3. Complete all required fields: date, species, interaction type, and location
4. Tap Submit to DFO

Form 222 submissions are logged and retained in your transmission register. If a submission fails, use the Retry button.

7. Form 233 — Inactivity Report

Form 233 is required when you have not fished during a reporting period. This form must be submitted to DFO to account for periods of inactivity.

To submit Form 233 in LobsterLog:

1. Navigate to the DFO Logs screen
2. Tap Inactivity Report (Form 233)
3. Enter the start and end dates of the inactive period (format: YYYY-MM-DD)
4. Select the reason for inactivity from the dropdown
5. Tap Submit to DFO

8. GPS and Coordinates

LobsterLog can automatically read your device GPS to record set and haul coordinates. Allow location access when prompted on first use.

If GPS is unavailable or you prefer to enter coordinates manually, tap the coordinate field and type your latitude and longitude in decimal degrees (e.g., 43.4567 N, 65.7890 W). Coordinates must be within the valid range for your fishing area.

The app includes a map view showing your set locations, heatmaps of your fishing activity, and tide information to assist with planning.

9. Language / Langue

LobsterLog is available in English and French. To change your language, navigate to Settings > Language and select your preferred official language. The app will reload in the selected language.

Note

The French version of this Provider's Instructions document (Instructions du fournisseur) is available at lobsterlog.ca/instructions and within the app under Settings > Provider's Instructions.

10. Corrections and Data Integrity

The data transmitted to DFO accurately represents what was entered by the fish harvester. LobsterLog does not alter submitted data. As required by DFO (Phase 1 ELOG standard), fish harvesters are the only users who enter data, and no manual alteration is made by the service provider.

If you need to correct a submitted entry:

- Contact DFO Client Support at 1-877-535-7307 for corrections to already-submitted data
- Contact LobsterLog support at support@lobsterlog.com for app-related issues
- LobsterLog support requires DFO approval before modifying any transmitted data

11. Offline Use

LobsterLog stores all logbook data locally on your device. You can create, edit, and review entries without an Internet connection. An Internet connection is required only when transmitting entries to DFO.

This Provider's Instructions document, the DFO Instructions (Form 234 v234.7), and all app help functions are stored on your device and accessible at all times without Internet access, as required by DFO.

12. Support

12.1 LobsterLog App Support

Contact LobsterLog for:

- App setup and configuration
- ELOG key entry and activation
- How to use app features
- Technical troubleshooting
- GPS manual entry assistance

Email: support@lobsterlog.com

Phone / text: 1 (902) 635-1069

Website: lobsterlog.ca

Supplier info listed at: dfo-mpo.gc.ca/qualified/index.htm

12.2 DFO Client Support

Contact DFO for:

- Corrections to already-submitted data
- ELOG key retrieval
- Licensing and regulatory questions

DFO Client Support: 1-877-535-7307

Hours: Monday to Friday, 08:00 to 21:00 Atlantic Time

Website: dfo-mpo.gc.ca/elogs

13. Document Information

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Contact: support@lobsterlog.com